DRAFT: cover wording and title are not final. Contact: pypteltd@gmail.com (business email for now, to be changed later)

Maths puzzles for early finishers

Early Finisher Puzzles

Primary 1

Semester 2

Terms 3 and 4

20 single-page puzzles
Almost every puzzle checks itself
One star and two star pages
Teacher answer key included

This booklet belongs to

_____

Preciouslyours Pte Ltd, trading as Math Inquirers

Photocopy licence (DRAFT)

DRAFT: the licence wording is a placeholder and is still open: it must be approved by a lawyer before any school receives this booklet. Contact: pypteltd@gmail.com (business email for now, to be changed later)

Licensed to: _____ (one school, one campus)

You may

- Print this PDF and photocopy any page for the pupils and staff of the school named above.
- Keep the file on the school network and share it with the school's teachers.
- Hand a single page to a pupil, or keep a tray of pages in the classroom.

You may not

- Sell, lend or give the pages or the file to another school, tuition centre or person.
- Post the file or pages on a public website or a shared platform outside the school.
- Edit the pages, or remove the licence line at the foot of each page.

Term

This is an annual licence: it covers one school year and is renewable. Licence wording to be approved by a lawyer before any school receives this booklet.

Printed copies

Printed sets: details to follow. Contact: pypteltd@gmail.com (business email for now, to be changed later). Registered office: 66 Tannery Ln, Singapore 347805

Notes

The licence is for the edition bought. The school name is written on the line marked School (write name) at the foot of each page, by hand or when the booklet is made. This licence covers Semester 2 only; the other semester booklet is licensed separately.

Not affiliated with or endorsed by the Ministry of Education, Singapore. The mathematics syllabus is published by the Ministry of Education, Singapore.

© 2026 Preciouslyours Pte Ltd.

Teacher notes (DRAFT)

DRAFT: teacher notes are for owner review. Contact: pypteltd@gmail.com (business email for now, to be changed later)

What this is

Twenty single-page maths puzzles for Primary 1 pupils who finish their work early. This is Semester 2 of two booklets (Terms 3 and 4). Each page stands alone, so you can hand out one page or keep a tray of pages. The pupil needs no help to start.

Which terms

The pages are grouped by the order in which Primary 1 topics are typically taught: this booklet follows Terms 3 and 4, the other booklet follows Semester 1 (Terms 1 and 2). Schools vary, so check your scheme of work: use a page whenever its topic has been taught, from either booklet.

Stars

One star pages practise a topic as it is usually taught (9 pages). Two star pages use the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine (11 pages).

How the pages check themselves

The boxed strip at the foot of each page tells the pupil how to check. The check shows that something is wrong. It does not give the answer, and it asks the pupil to see whether the answer makes sense. Every answer box and every letter box must be filled: a box left blank gives no letter, and the check cannot see it. On the Measure and Draw page the check tests reading the ruler and finding the end mark; look at the line the pupil draws at a glance.

- **Code word.** The answers give letters that spell a word. The strip gives no hint of the word. Each word can be spelt from its letters in one way only, so answers in the wrong boxes never make another word.
- **Colour by code.** Each answer is found in a key of five numbers and the part is coloured with that crayon. The pupil counts the parts of each colour and compares with the box on the page; matching parts must share a colour.
- **Route.** The line must reach FINISH through the stated number of boxes, and every box on it must follow the rule on the page.
- **Total.** The whole count must make the total printed in the strip (the graph pages add a second sum).

Marking is not needed. To spot-check, look only at the check strip.

How the checks were tested

A script tried every single wrong answer and every wrong arrangement on every page. Each check rejected at least 95% of them. A wrong answer that spells any of about 129 000 English words counts as not rejected. Two wrong answers at once were not all tested.

Teacher notes: using the pages (DRAFT)

Using the pages

- **Time.** Most pages take 5 to 15 minutes; the colour-by-code pages (S2-03) take longer because pupils colour a picture. Pupils need their own crayons (five colours: yellow, red, blue, green, orange). For a pencil-only copy the pupil writes Y, R, B, G or O in each part; the tally and the matching parts are checked the same way. Light crayons work best: a dark crayon hides the number in the part on a photocopy.
- **If the check fails.** The pupil goes back, looks for the slip, and asks a friend or you if still stuck.
- **Problem solving.** Some pages (S2-02, S2-11, S2-12, S2-13, S2-20) practise the kinds of question that appear in school tests, such as stories with more than one step, fewest coins, choosing two things for an exact price and printed facts, rather than one numbered syllabus outcome. The key tags them problem solving.
- **Stars.** One star: one skill, as usually taught. Two stars: the same topics with two steps or two clues to combine.

Photocopying

All pages are black and white with solid lines, so they copy cleanly. Each page is one side only. Pupils write on the page: the boxes are large for young hands. Use A4 and print at 100% (actual size); on the ruler pages a real ruler matches the drawn ruler only at 100%.

Contents: Semester 2

Page	Code	Puzzle	Tier
S2-01	P1-03	Fair Shares	1 star
S2-02	P1-39	Share and Group	2 stars
S2-03	P1-14	Colour the Ice Cream	2 stars
S2-04	P1-05	Times Code	2 stars
S2-05	P1-40	True or False	2 stars
S2-06	P1-11	Big Number Sums	2 stars
S2-07	P1-23	Stack It Up	1 star
S2-08	P1-32	Measure and Draw	1 star
S2-09	P1-06	What Time Is It?	1 star
S2-10	P1-15	Coin Purses	1 star
S2-11	P1-28	Fewest Coins	1 star
S2-12	P1-16	Shop Prices	2 stars
S2-13	P1-27	Which Two Items?	2 stars
S2-14	P1-18	Clock Time	2 stars
S2-15	P1-30	Morning or Evening?	1 star
S2-16	P1-29	How Long Does It Last?	1 star
S2-17	P1-35	Read the Picture Graph	1 star
S2-18	P1-20	Fruit Graph	2 stars
S2-19	P1-36	Graph Detective Two	2 stars
S2-20	P1-22	Two-Step Stories	2 stars

Pages are independent. The footer code shows the page in this booklet and, in brackets, its number in the full set of 40 (P1-01 to P1-40).

What the booklet covers

Whole Numbers 1.6 patterns in number sequences **S2-03**

Addition and Subtraction 2.1 concepts of addition and subtraction **S2-20**

Addition and Subtraction 2.2 use of +, - and = **S2-20**

Addition and Subtraction 2.5 adding and subtracting within 100 **S2-06, S2-07, S2-13, S2-20**

Addition and Subtraction 2.6 adding and subtracting using algorithms **S2-07**

Addition and Subtraction 2.7 mental calculation involving addition and subtraction (within 20; 2-digit number and ones without renaming; 2-digit number and tens) **S2-06, S2-12, S2-20**

Multiplication and Division 3.1 concepts of multiplication and division **S2-01, S2-02, S2-04, S2-05**

Multiplication and Division 3.2 use of x **S2-04, S2-05**

Multiplication and Division 3.3 multiplying within 40 **S2-04, S2-05**

Multiplication and Division 3.4 dividing within 20 **S2-01, S2-02**

Money 1.1 counting amount of money (in cents up to $1; in dollars up to $100) **S2-10, S2-11, S2-12, S2-13**

Length 1.1 measuring length in centimetres **S2-08**

Length 1.2 use of abbreviation cm **S2-08**

Length 1.4 measuring and drawing a line segment to the nearest cm **S2-08**

Time 2.1 telling time to 5 minutes **S2-09, S2-14, S2-15, S2-16**

Time 2.2 use of 'am' and 'pm' **S2-15**

Time 2.3 use of abbreviations h and min **S2-16**

Time 2.4 duration of one hour/half hour **S2-14, S2-16**

Picture Graphs 1.1 reading and interpreting data from picture graphs **S2-17, S2-18, S2-19**

Outcomes practised in the other booklet: Whole Numbers 1.1; Whole Numbers 1.2; Whole Numbers 1.3; Whole Numbers 1.4; Whole Numbers 1.5; Whole Numbers 1.7; Addition and Subtraction 2.3; Addition and Subtraction 2.4; Length 1.3; 2D Shapes 1.1; 2D Shapes 1.2; 2D Shapes 1.3; 2D Shapes 1.4.